Day 1: Getting Started

We began the program with an orientation and an overview of the topics we'd be covering. It helped me understand what to expect and how the different parts of the course fit together. We then set up a Level 3 portable repository, which gave us an organized place to work on our code.

After that, we took some logic we'd built in Scratch and rewrote it in C++. This helped me see how visual programming ideas translate into written code. I spent the rest of the day coding and fixing small errors as I got used to the new environment. By the end, I felt positive and ready to learn more.

Day 2: Variables, Calculations and Automation

On Day 2, we covered some of the basics of working with data in C++, including data types, literals, variables and constants. We also practised writing arithmetic expressions and learned how operator precedence affects calculations. I learned how to format output and check user input so programs can handle it properly.

We used these ideas to build an application with the C++ math library and other useful libraries. The facilitator was energetic and explained things clearly, which helped keep me motivated through a busy day. We finished by adding our work to our Portfolio of Evidence (POE) and pushing it to GitHub. It felt good to finish the day with something completed.

Day 3: Making Decisions and Controlling Program Flow

We continued with the same facilitator on Day 3 and focused on how a program makes decisions and follows different paths. We worked with logical operators and used `if`, `else if` and `switch` statements to make our code respond to different conditions.

In the afternoon, we moved on to loops. We practised sentinel-controlled loops, which continue until a set condition is reached, and nested loops for working with more complex data. We finished with a POE task and uploaded our work to GitHub. The explanations and pace made it easier to follow the new ideas.

Day 4: Functions and Arrays

Day 4 was the most challenging one for me. We moved on to functions and learned about prototypes, passing values and references, reusable functions and generating random numbers. We also started working with one-dimensional arrays.

There was a lot to take in, and at times I lost track of the logic, especially when working with arrays. It was a tiring day, but I kept going and completed the POE tasks. I came away knowing that I need to spend more time reviewing these topics.

Day 5: Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming

We ended the week with one of my favourite topics: Object-Oriented Programming (OOP). We looked at how classes and objects can be used to represent real-world information. I learned about attributes, methods and constructors, and how constructors help set up objects.